QUICK REFERENCE CARD

S3 CH05: The Potter's Valley — Season 3: Makers and Creators

Episode Summary

The friends arrive at Potter's Valley where Celeste teaches them pottery. She guides them through wedging clay, centering it on the wheel, and pulling up the walls to make bowls. They discover that patience and craft require gentle hands, complete attention, and time.

Vocabulary: Word | Gesture | Definition

Word	Gesture	Quick Definition
kiln	Open oven door (both hands)	Special hot oven for pottery
vessel	Cup hands like holding bowl	Container / bowl / pot
symmetry	Mirror hands left-right	Both sides match perfectly
patient	Slow breath, hands folded	Calm, not rushing
craft	Mime shaping clay	Skill learned with hands

Pause Points

Scene/Time	What Happens	Discussion Question
Scene 5 (~2:00)	Potter explains clay needs gentle hands and patience; rushing makes it collapse	**All:** Why do you think the Potter says clay needs patience? **Level A:** What does Celeste say about being gentle? **Level D:** How is clay different from wood?
Scene 12 (~4:48)	Potter demonstrates centering; explains "center yourself first, clay will follow"	**All:** What does Celeste mean by "center yourself first"? **Level A:** What is Celeste doing to the clay? **Level D:** Why might your calmness affect the clay?
Scene 18 (~7:12)	Friends try to pull up clay; everything must balance	**All:** What makes pulling up the clay so difficult? **Level A:** What are the friends making? **Level D:** What specific things need to balance?

LEAPS Timing

Phase	Level A	Level B	Level C	Level D
Launch	7 min	6 min	5 min	5 min
Explore	10 min	10 min	10 min	10 min
Apply	10 min	15 min	18 min	20 min

Cognates (English → Spanish)

English	Spanish (syllables)
vessel	vasija (va-SI-ja)
symmetry	simetría (si-me-TRÍ-a)
patient	paciente (pa-CIEN-te)

Practice	5 min	7 min	10 min	12 min
Share	3 min	3 min	4 min	5 min
TOTAL	**35 min**	**41 min**	**47 min**	**52 min**

craft	artesanía (ar-te-sa-NÍ-a)

Spanish-dominant students:
Flag cognates during Launch: "Esta palabra en español es ___"

QUICK REFERENCE CARD — SIDE 2

S3 CH05: The Potter's Valley

Level Differentiation at a Glance

Phase	Level A	Level B	Level C	Level D
Launch	Oral, gesture only	Write before/after definitions	Morphology notes	Predict from roots
Explore	Draw in boxes	Sentence frames	Open prompts	Write + questions
Apply	Teacher reads aloud	Partner reading	Independent reading	Independent + footnotes
Practice	Teacher scribes	Sentence frames	Starter provided	No starter, analytical
Share	Whole-class pair	Structured pairs	Small groups (3-4)	Student questions

Formative Check Rubric

Behavior	Not Yet	Approaching	Got It
Uses vocabulary in writing	No vocab words	1 word attempted	2+ words correct
Provides specific evidence	Generic / "I said"	Vague mention	Specific detail
Response matches prompt	Retells episode	Partial address	Direct answer

Designated ELD Extension

Emerging (Beginning): Point to the picture that shows a kiln
Expanding (Intermediate): Use the word "vessel" in a sentence about pottery
Bridging (Advanced): Explain what symmetry means with your own example

⚠️ **ANSWER KEY — TEACHER EYES ONLY** ⚠️

Level C Sample Answers

Question	Proficient Answer
Q1 (MC): What must potters do before shaping clay?	**C)** Wedge it to remove air bubbles
Q2 (MC): Why does the vessel dry slowly?	**B)** To prevent cracking (rushing causes cracking)
Q3: Find a sentence showing pottery requires patience	Sample acceptable answers: • "After shaping, the vessel dries slowly for several days."

	• "The firing process takes many hours." • "This touch takes years to develop."
Q4: Why does the author mention "over two thousand years"?	Sample: To show this is a real tradition that has lasted a long time and is important to the culture. It's not something new or made up.

Vocabulary Context Clues (Level C)

Word	Expected Answer
kiln	A special oven that gets very hot. Clues: "explode", "hot", "firing"
vessel	The pot or bowl that was made. Clue: "pottery" is mentioned right after

Tech Backup Reminder

If episode unavailable: Use Read-Aloud Backup (separate PDF). Same pause points, same questions, same outcomes.

Quick Substitution Note

No pottery knowledge needed! Follow LEAPS phases, ask questions on each page, circulate during work time. Student packs guide every activity.